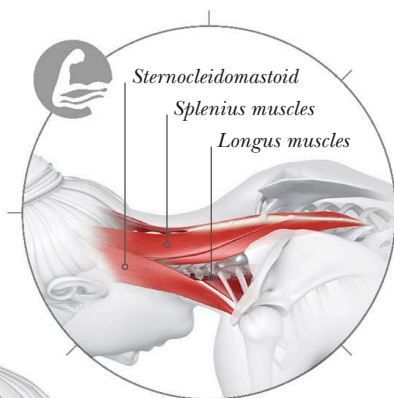


» CLOSER LOOK

Plank can be used to explore yogic energetic locks, called *bandhas*. In this version, notice subtle activation in the areas of the *bandhas* while breathing. You can practice engaging the *bandhas* under instruction from a qualified teacher.

Jalandhara bandha

Jalandhara means “net holding” in Sanskrit; the *bandha* is so called because fishermen in ancient India would hold nets under their chins. This pose engages your neck muscles in a subtle but similar way as you lift your head up against gravity. Traditionally, this is done while seated, and with the glottis closed for breath retention (*kumbhaka*). However, you should keep breathing while in plank.



Crown of the head reaches forward

Rotator cuff muscles engage to stabilize shoulders



Thoracic outlet diaphragm (including the neck and thorax muscles and the glottis)

Respiratory diaphragm

Abdominals move freely with breath

Pelvic floor diaphragm

Serratus anterior muscles engage to prevent your shoulder blades from winging out

Wrists are extended

Three diaphragms

Some researchers describe the three areas of the *bandhas* as the “three diaphragms,” shown on the image above. According to this model, these three oscillate between engagement and release freely in a healthy breath.